

COS30049 - Computing Technology Innovation Project

Workshop Guide

Workshop 03

Monitoring and Controlling in Project Management & Usability of a Web Project

Objectives:

By the end of this workshop, students will be able to:

1. Understand the key concepts of project monitoring and controlling.
2. Apply these concepts through practical exercises and case studies.
3. Develop skills to manage and control project progress, quality, and risks effectively.
4. Understand the principles of usability and apply them to web projects.

Part 1: Recap of the Lecture Content (10 minutes)

This recap will highlight the essential elements of the lecture and review the concepts you will need for future assignments. Please go through the lecture slides for each of the concepts listed below and discuss them in class.

- Change Control
  - **Definition:** A process that ensures that changes to a project are introduced in a controlled and coordinated manner, reducing the possibility that unnecessary changes will be introduced to the project without due forethought. It includes all necessary changes to the project, while ensuring that only approved changes are implemented.
- Change Control Board:
  - **Definition:** A Change Control Board (CCB) is a group of stakeholders responsible for reviewing, evaluating, approving, or rejecting changes to a project.
  - **Purpose:** The CCB ensures that all changes are systematically considered and aligned with the project's objectives, scope, budget, and timeline.
- Change Log:
  - **Definition:** A Change Log is a document or tool used to record all change requests, their status, and their impact on the project.
  - **Purpose:** Provides a historical record of all changes, facilitating tracking, accountability, and communication
- Risk Management:
  - **Definition:** Involves identifying, analyzing, and responding to project risks to minimize their impact on the project.
- Usability:
  - **Definition:** The ease of use and learnability of a human-made object such as a tool or device.
- Understanding Usability Principles:
  - List and explain Nielsen's Usability Heuristics
  - Are there any other principles we can apply?

Part 2: Read a Case Study (5 mins)

Following this, you will enter the group practice phase. Please gather with your teammates to collaboratively complete the case study in Part 2 and proceed with the activities from Parts 2 through 5.

Case Study: Organising a University Conference

Scenario:

You have been tasked with organising a university conference titled “Innovations in Technology.” The conference will feature keynote speakers, panel discussions, workshops, and networking sessions. It is scheduled to take place over two days in November. Your responsibilities include planning, coordinating, and executing the conference, ensuring all aspects are covered from logistics to marketing.

Project Requirements:

- **Venue:** Secure a suitable venue that can accommodate 200 attendees, with breakout rooms for workshops.
- **Speakers:** Confirm keynote speakers and panelists, and arrange their travel and accommodation.
- **Workshops:** Organize 4 workshops on different technology topics, each with a capacity of 50 participants.
- **Marketing:** Promote the conference through various channels to ensure maximum attendance.
- **Registration:** Set up an online registration system and manage attendee registrations.
- **Logistics:** Arrange catering, audio-visual equipment, and materials for the conference.

Part 3: Change Control (15 mins)

Now that you've read the case study, you will work with your teammates to address potential changes that could impact the success of the conference. Discuss how to handle the following scenarios using change control strategies:

Scenario 1: A keynote speaker cancels a month before the conference.

- Questions to Consider:
    1. What immediate actions should be taken to mitigate the impact of this cancellation?
    2. How will you communicate this change to the attendees and other stakeholders?
    3. What alternatives can be considered, such as replacing the speaker or reshuffling the agenda?

Scenario 2: A venue room is no longer available.

- Questions to Consider:
    1. What are the possible consequences of losing the venue room?
    2. What are your options for finding an alternative space or rearranging the current venue setup?

3. How will this change affect other aspects of the conference, such as workshop scheduling and attendee experience?

Activity:

Use a Change Control Board (CCB) approach to evaluate these scenarios. Each group will act as a CCB, discussing the pros and cons of proposed changes, and making a collective decision on how to proceed. Record your decisions in the Change Log.

Part 4: Risk Management (20 mins)

In this section, your group will focus on identifying and managing potential risks associated with organizing the conference. Consider the entire project lifecycle, from initial planning through to the execution phase.

Risk Identification:

Activity:

- Brainstorm potential risks in areas such as logistics, speaker availability, attendee satisfaction, technical failures, and marketing outreach.
- List at least five risks and categorize them by likelihood (High, Medium, Low) and impact (High, Medium, Low).

Risk Assessment:

Activity:

For each identified risk, discuss:

1. What is the potential impact on the project's success?
2. How likely is each risk to occur, based on the current project environment?
3. Which risks should be prioritized based on their severity?

Risk Response Plan:

Activity:

For the top three risks identified, develop a Risk Response Plan, document your Risk Response Plan, outlining the specific actions to be taken for each risk and who will be responsible for implementing these actions.

Risk Monitoring and Control Strategy:

Activity:

Develop a Risk Monitoring and Control strategy for your top risks. This strategy should include:

1. Ongoing Monitoring: Establish procedures for regularly reviewing the status of identified risks.
2. Trigger Points: Identify specific events or thresholds that will prompt further action or escalation.
3. Communication Plan: Determine how updates on risk status will be communicated to stakeholders.

Part 5: Project Closure and Acceptance Criteria (20 mins)

In this final section, your group will focus on developing a Closure Plan for the conference project, including defining the acceptance criteria that will determine the project's successful completion.

Activity:

Write a brief Closure Plan, including the defined acceptance criteria. This plan should outline what needs to be completed, reviewed, and approved for the project to be officially closed.

Part 6: Design your prototype (40 mins)

Your group will design a simplified prototype system that represents the basic functionality of the selected project. After your group has discussed the design, you will have the opportunity to present it to the client (tutor) to ensure that the requirements and the prototype meet the system's functionality. You can create the prototype using any of the following methods:

- sketches on paper
- hand-drawn sketches on an iPad
- design tool
    - Axure https://www.axure.com/
    - Sketch https://www.sketch.com/
    - Figma https://www.figma.com/
    - Powerpoint
    - Or other prototype tools

You will have 25 minutes on prototype designing and 15 minutes to discuss with the client.

Note: Below is a example to guide you on what to consider before designing a movie recommendation system

Scenario: Movie Recommendation System

Create a basic prototype of a movie recommendation system that leverages machine learning to suggest movies based on user preferences. Focus on the core features essential for a functional prototype.

Key Considerations:

First, all designs should incorporate Usability Principles, then:

1. User Needs:

- **User Personas:** Understand who your users are and what they're looking for (e.g., discovering new movies, finding similar films).
- **Preferences:** Design the interface to allow easy input of preferences like genres, actors, and past favorites.

2. Visual Design:

- **Theme & Color:** Choose a consistent theme and color scheme that aligns with the project's purpose (e.g., dark for cinematic, light for casual).

- **Buttons & UI:** Design clear, easy-to-use buttons with consistent styles and sufficient contrast. Use hover effects or animations for better interactivity.

3. Core Requirements for the Prototype:

- **User Input Interface:** A simple, intuitive interface for users to input their movie preferences, such as favorite genres, actors, or previous movies they enjoyed.
- **Recommendation Display:** A visually appealing list or grid of recommended movies, including essential details such as the movie title, genre, rating, and a brief synopsis.
- **Interactive Dashboard:** A basic dashboard providing an overview of recommended movies, with filters for narrowing down recommendations by criteria like genre or release year.
- **Feedback Mechanism:** An easy-to-use feedback system allowing users to provide thumbs up/down or star ratings on recommended movies, which the system uses to refine future suggestions.

Part 7: Reflection (5 minutes)

A. Discuss what was learned during the workshop.

B. Address any questions or concerns from students.